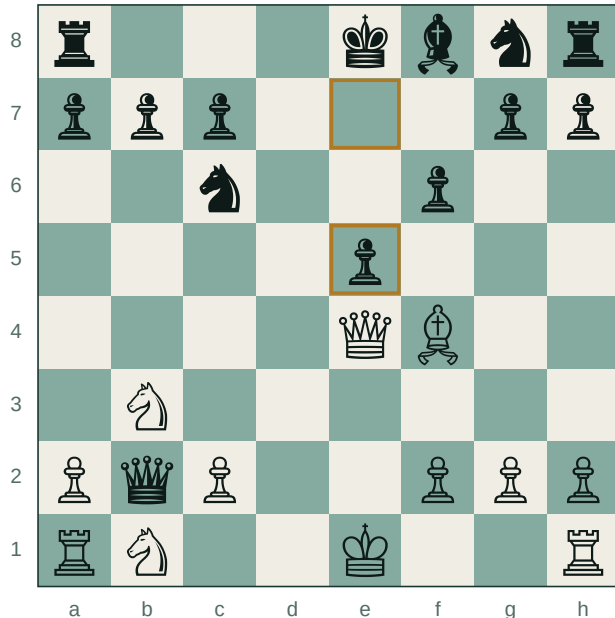


Trapping a piece: White, move 10

Trapping a piece

White to move



Previous move: 9...e5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

10. Bc1 Bb4+ 11. Kf1 Qxa1 12. Nxa1

10.Bc1 The bishop moves from f4 to c1. Recorded reply: **10...Bb4+**.

11.Kf1 The king moves from e1 to f1. Recorded reply: **11...Qxa1**.

12.Nxa1 The knight captures the queen on a1.

At the end, nominal material is White 28 / Black 26 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +4: the balance goes from -2 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attacked piece is not trapped if it can give check, trade itself favorably, or open an escape through a sacrifice.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A trapped piece lacks safe retreat squares. Winning it usually requires restricting its routes before attacking it, or forcing it into a cage.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace every plausible escape square for the target, including captures and counterchecks. Then find the move that closes the remaining route.

The defending king is on e8. Absolute pin: pawn on e5.